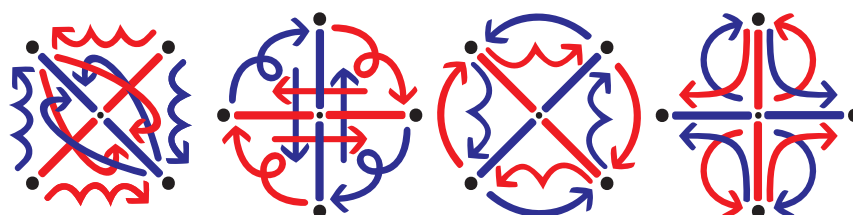


1.0



Positions

Motions



The Grid

The Kinetic Alphabet is based on a 4-point grid.

There are two 4-point grids: box mode and diamond mode.

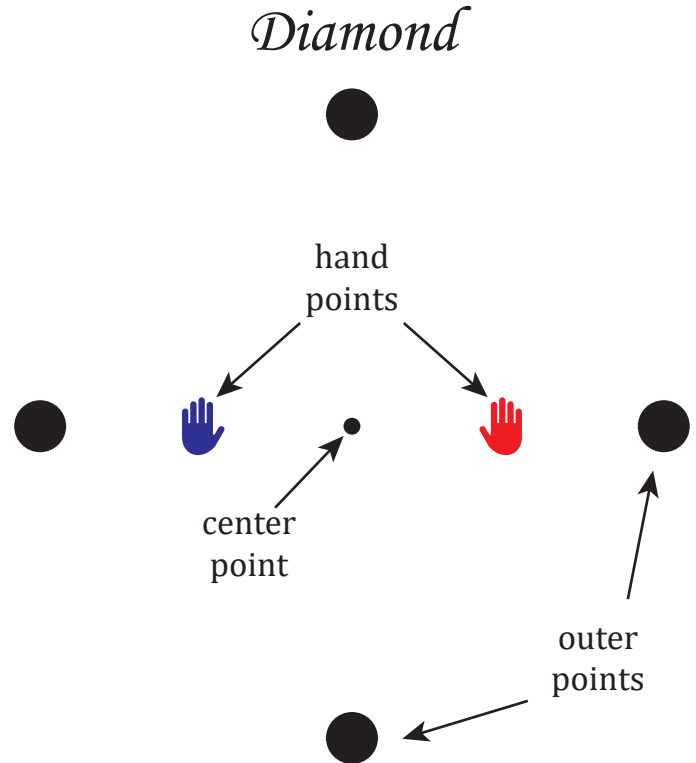
This guide is written in diamond, but everything translates to box.

On this grid, there are three types of points:

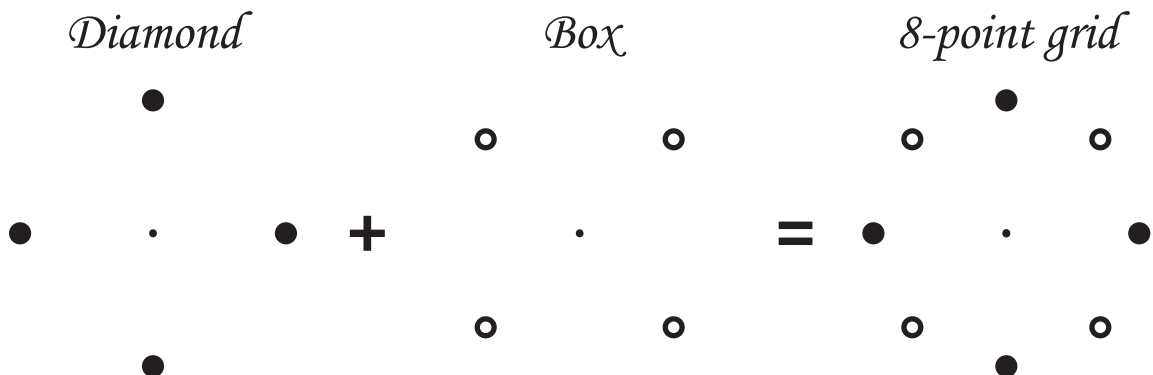
The **center point** is the hub that everything revolves around.

The four **hand points** are halfway between the center point and the outer points.

The **outer points** depict the outer edges of the grid.



Together, diamond and box form an 8-point grid:



For now, we'll use diamond mode to learn each concept.

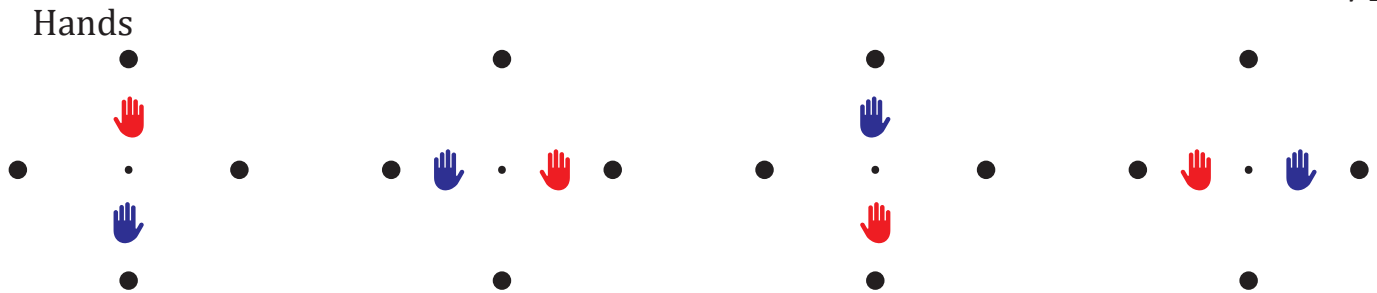
Hand Positions

There are multiple ways to combine two hand points to form a hand position.
As shown in these variations, positions can be rotated or mirrored.
Red = Right and **Blue = Left**,

In The Kinetic Alphabet, our first three positions are called Alpha, Beta, and Gamma.

α Alpha

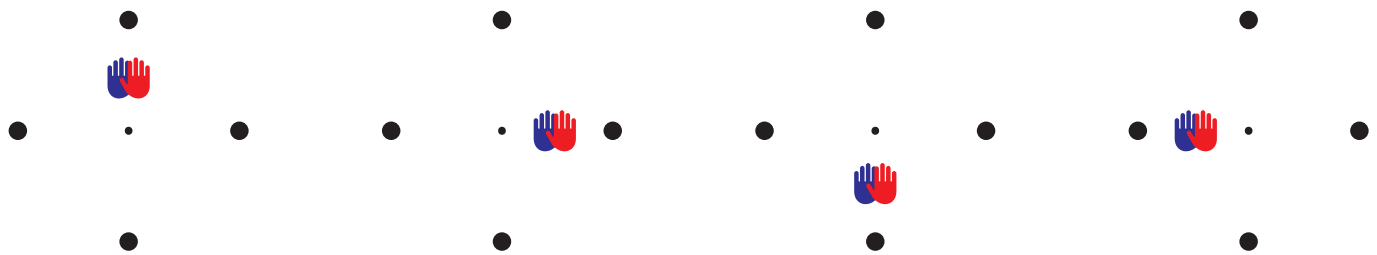
VTG: SS



In Alpha, the hands occupy the points across from each other.

β Beta

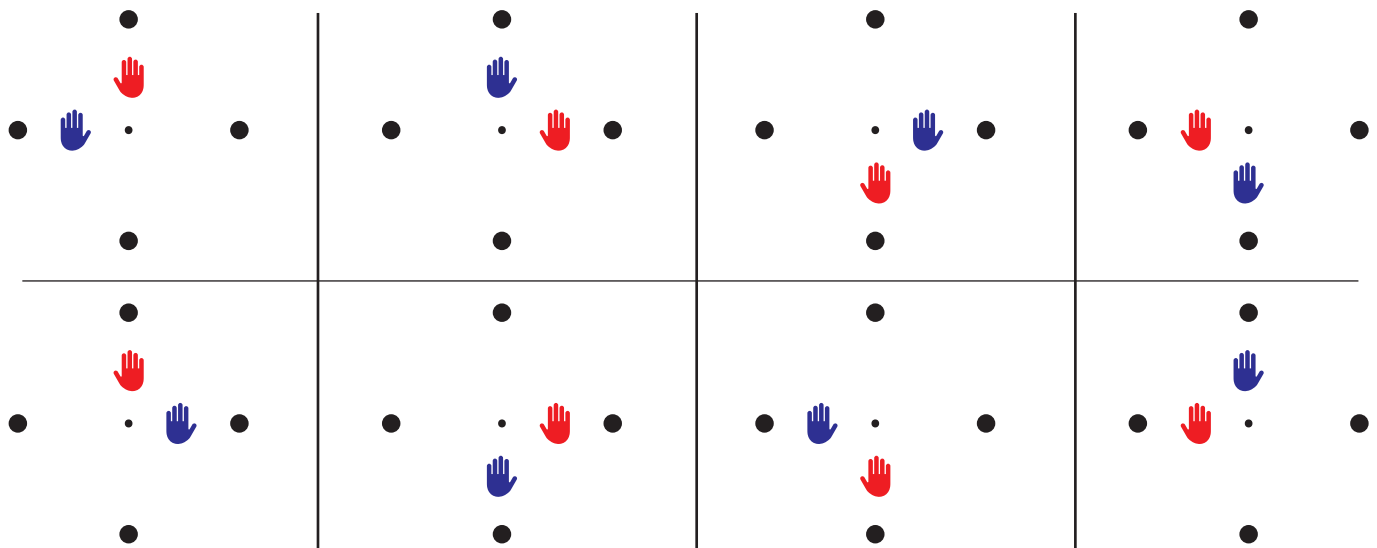
VTG: TS



In Beta, the hands occupy the same point.

Γ Gamma

VTG:
Quarter Time



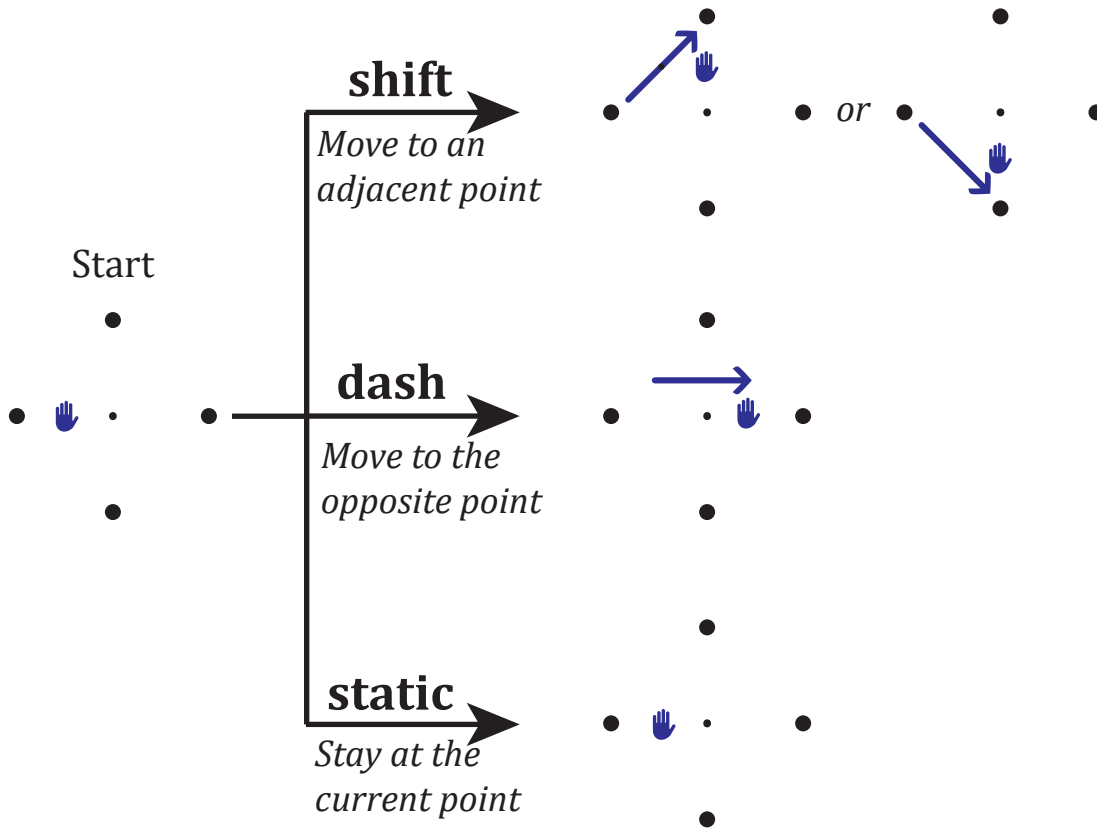
In Gamma, the hands form a right angle.

Hand Motions

There are three fundamental hand motions in the Alphabet.

The arrow shows the direction of motion.

The hand shows the end position.



Using these, we can derive six types of motion combinations, named below.

We will explore each one individually:

Dual-Shift

Both hands travel to an adjacent point.

Shift

One hand travels to an adjacent point and the other hand remains static.

Cross-Shift

One hand travels to an adjacent point and the other travels to the opposite point.

Dash

One hand travels to the opposite point and the other hand remains static.

Dual-Dash

Both hands travel to the opposite point.

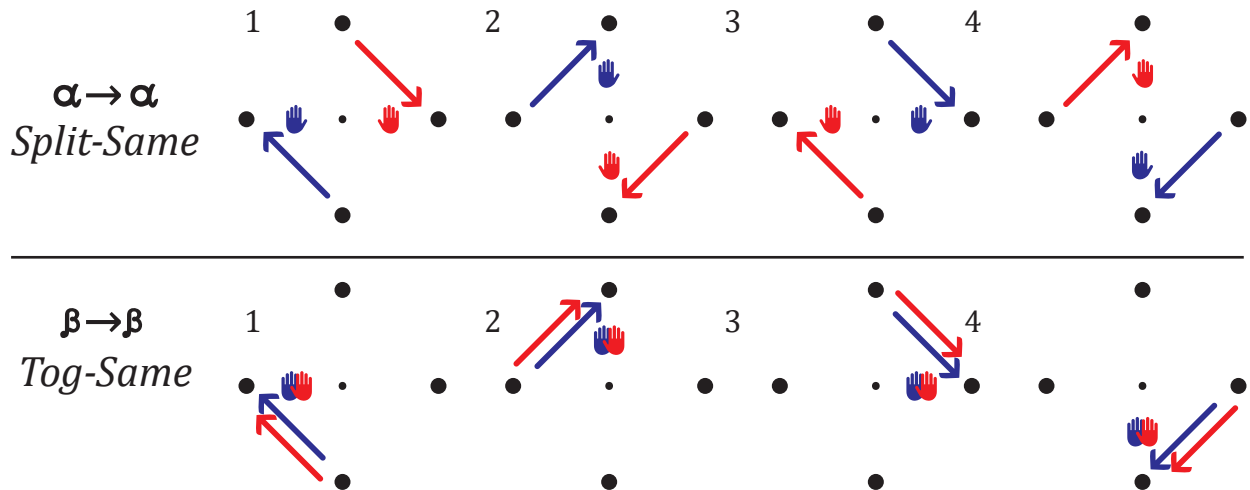
Static

Both hands remain static.

Type 1 - Dual-Shifts

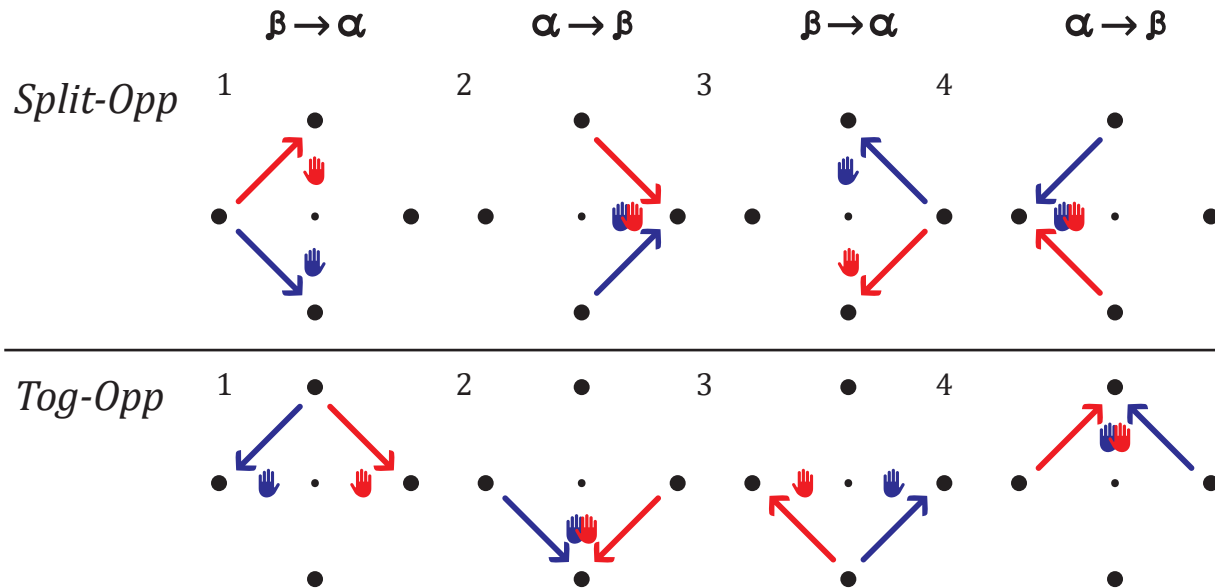
When both hands shift, it's called a **Dual-Shift**.

The Alpha/Beta **Dual-Shifts** correspond to the four modes in VTG - (SS, TS, SO, TO). You can determine the start position by looking at the non-pointed end of the arrow.



While VTG categorizes individual motions into the four modes based on the downbeat, TKA puts focus on the combination of two motions between positions, relative to the center point.

Let's try another type of **Dual-Shift**.
What happens when we move between α and β ?



Note that these combinations can be either *Split-Opp* or *Tog-Opp* depending on start position.

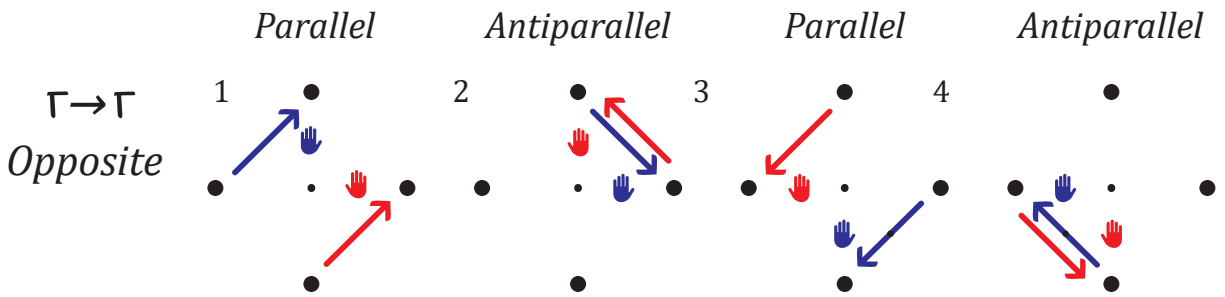
In TKA, these motions are considered $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ or $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$ regardless of the downbeat.

Its categorization doesn't delineate motions based on up/down (absolute).

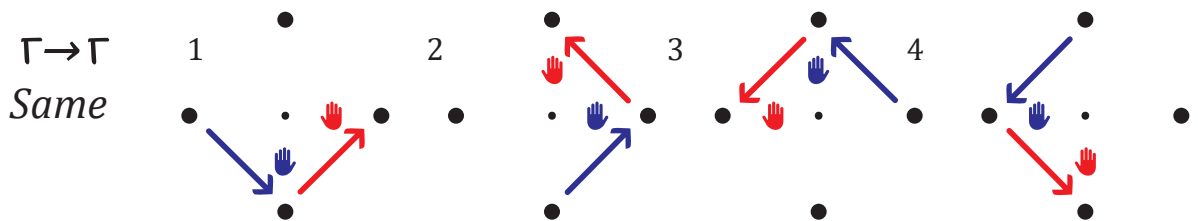
Instead, it focuses on the movement between positions related to the center point (relative).

Practice using **Dual-Shifts** to travel between Alpha and Beta in each mode.

Gamma, aka quarter-time, is not based on the four modes.
However we can separate the variations of $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$ into Opposite and Same direction.



Opposite direction presents variations of parallel and antiparallel.
In same direction, this is not a factor:

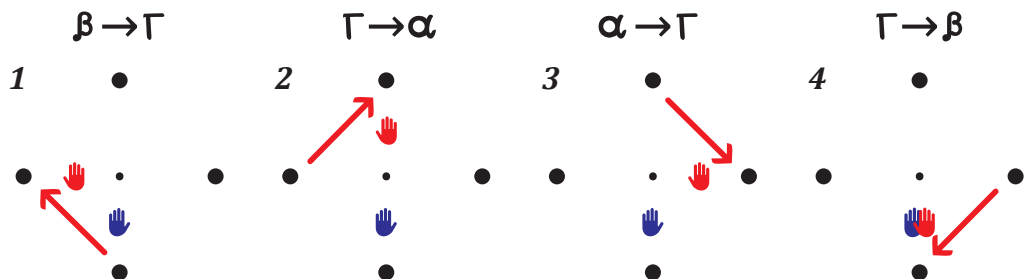


When in gamma, you can move to any other variation of gamma.
These examples are continuous, but non-continuous sequence are also possible.

Practice using Dual-Shifts to create non-continuous $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$ variations.

Type 2 - Shifts

To move between Γ and α/β , you can shift one hand and keep the other hand static.
This combination is called a **Shift** (with a capital "S").

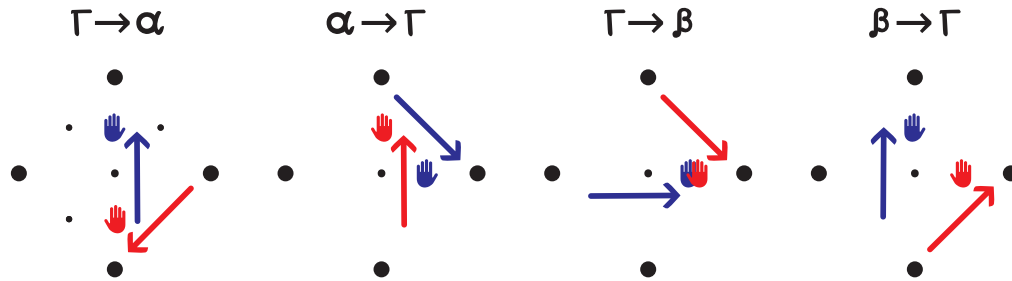


In these examples, the **right** hand is shifting, but it's equally valid to shift the **left** hand.

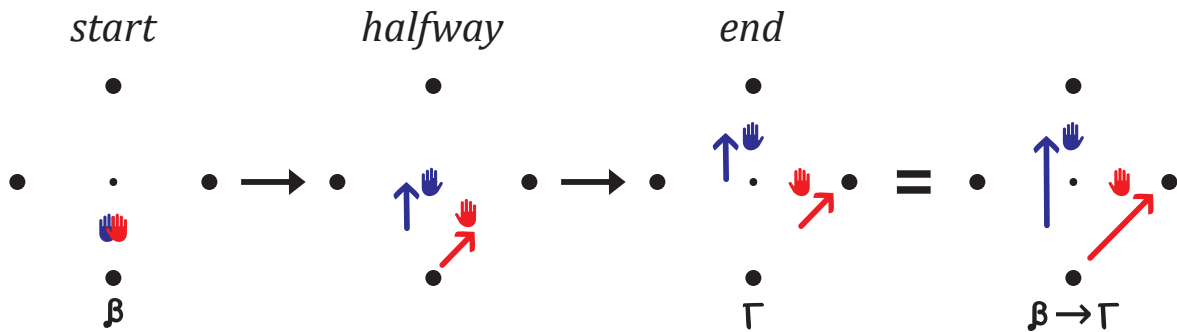
Practice using Shifts to travel between α/β and Γ in either direction with both hands.

Type 3 - Cross-Shifts

A **Cross-Shift** combines a shift and a dash.
Since a dash has further to travel, it moves slightly faster.



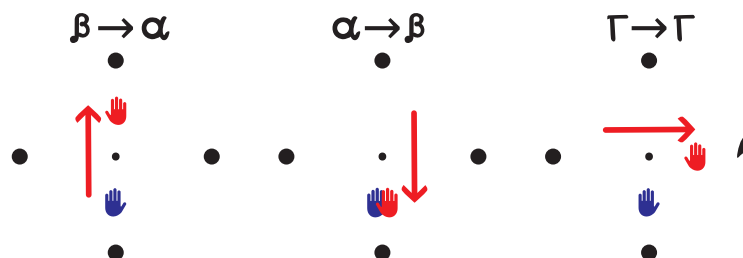
To understand **Cross-Shifts**, let's break one down into parts:



Note the halfway point. One hand is in the center point and one is on a diagonal hand point.
By pausing at this halfway point, it ensures that the dash moves at the correct speed.

Type 4 - Dash

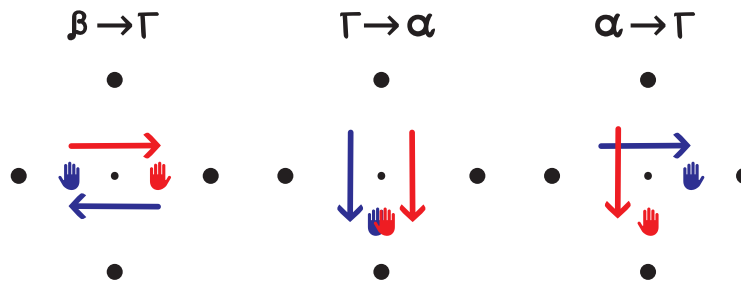
With a **Dash**, one hand executes a dash while the other hand remains static.



Just like before, the halfway position of each dash is at the center point.

Type 5 - Dual-Dash

With a **Dual-Dash**, both hands dash simultaneously to their opposite points.

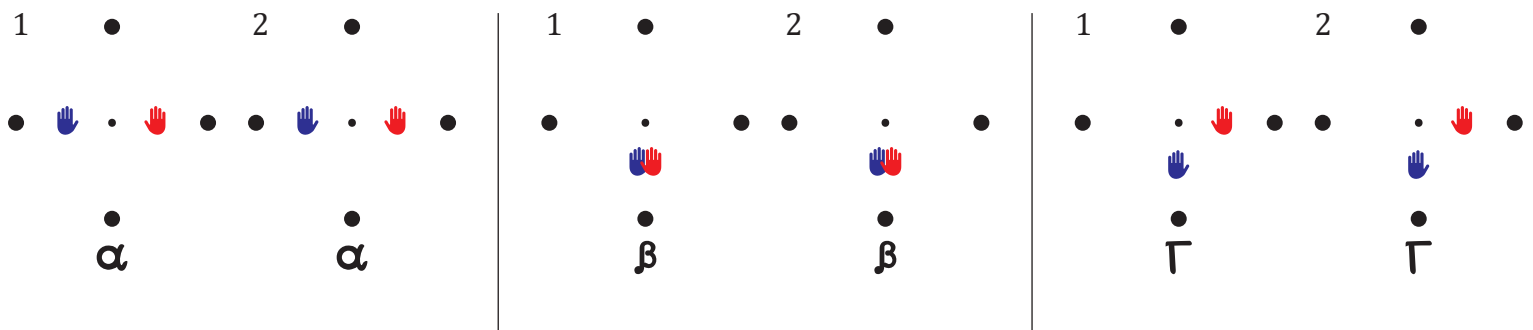


Practice using **Dual-Dashes**, **Dashes**, and **Cross-Shifts** from different start positions.

Type 6 - Static

The combination of two static motions can be written as **Static** (with a capital “S”).

To indicate any static motion, we simply draw the position.
Here are three **Static** 2-beat sequences.



Obviously these sequences aren't very exciting.

Later on, static sequences have more complexity when adding turns.

Staff Positions

When writing sequences with staves, it helps to mark the thumb end with a line. The performer can use it to keep track of rotations and check their position on every beat. It also encourages negative space/body turns instead of finger spinning.

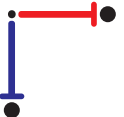
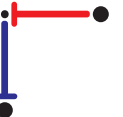
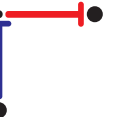
In the following examples, an end is always at the center point.

In The Kinetic Alphabet, this is called **Layer 1**.

We will learn much more about Layers in the future, but this is our starting point.

These variations are classified by the thumb end's relationship to the center point:

Practice each position below, paying attention to the thumb orientation.

Thumbs:	In	Out	(in/out)	(out/in)
 Alpha				
 Beta				
 Gamma				

Many of pictographs in this guide are depicted without thumb ends because it doesn't affect the letter categorization. It is only notated during sequences.

Most example sequences in this guide start with thumbs in for consistency. It's equally valid to start any sequence from a different thumb orientation.

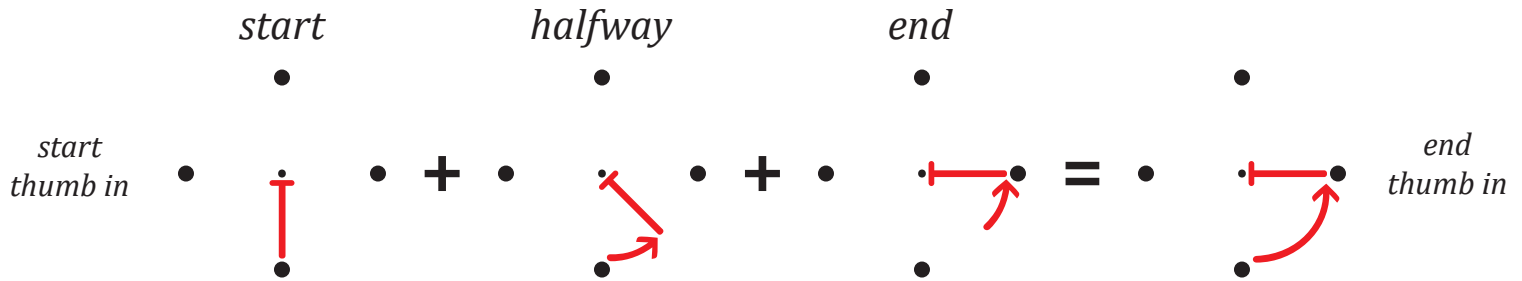
Staff Motions

Shift

During a shift, a prop can rotate in one of two directions - Prospin or Antispin

Prospin

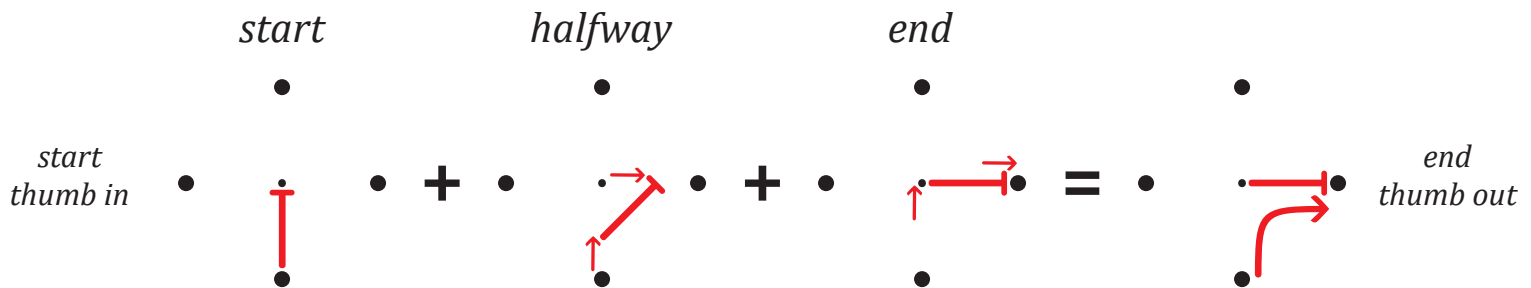
- **Prospin** - The prop rotates the same direction as the hand
A 90 degree isolation is our base unit of a prospin.



In a base isolation, the thumb orientation remains the same for the entire motion.

Antispin

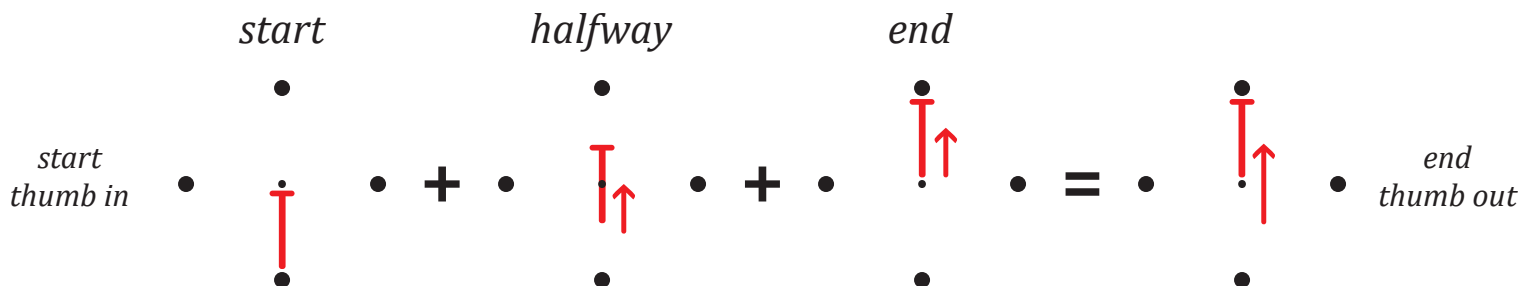
- **Antispin** - The prop rotates in the opposite direction of the hand
A 90 degree antispin is our base unit of antispin.



In an antispin, the ends switch orientation. Here, it moves from thumb in to thumb out.

Dash

In a base dash, the thumb orientation also switches.
At its halfway point, the center of the staff is at the center point.



Negative Space / Body Turns

Many sequences seem impossible, but most can be solved by using negative space or body turns.

Negative space lets you face the audience and reduces body movement

Body turns add movement and help you execute patterns with longer staves.

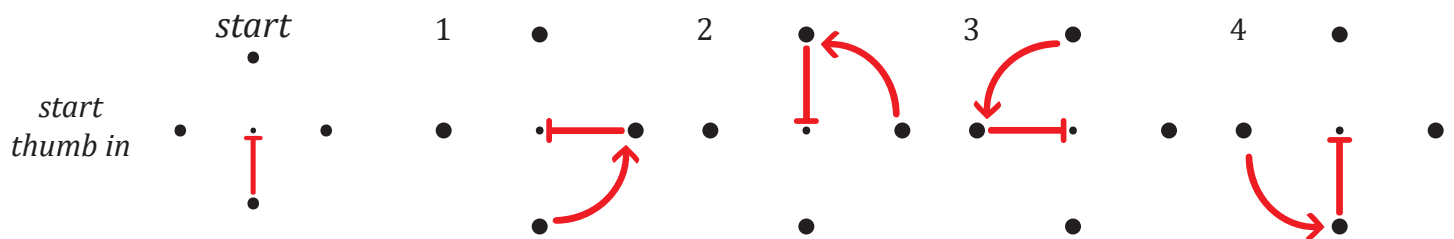
Each method is equally important, and learning both will maximize capability.

This guide will assume some knowledge of these fundamental concepts.

To make the most of the Alphabet, it's highly recommended that you learn the following.

VTG: 1:1

360° Isolation

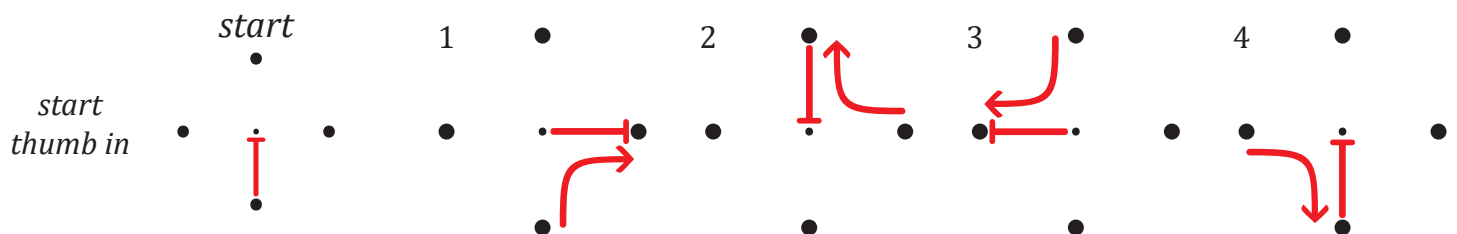


To execute this without finger-spinning, turn your torso to the left on beat 3. During this beat, the staff moves briefly in wheel-plane relative to your left-facing view. On beat 4, turn your body back to center as you return to the start position.

Practice it in reverse, then do both directions in the other hand.

Then practice it with the thumb out, isolating the pinky end.

4-Petal Antispin



To execute this in wall plane, you must do one of the following on beat 2:

- Pass the thumb end through the negative space above your right shoulder on beat 2.
 - Turn your torso to the left on beat 2 and pass the thumb end in front, then pass the pinky end on the inside of your right arm as you move to beat 3.
-

Practice it in reverse, then do both directions in the other hand.

Then practice it all again starting with the thumb out.

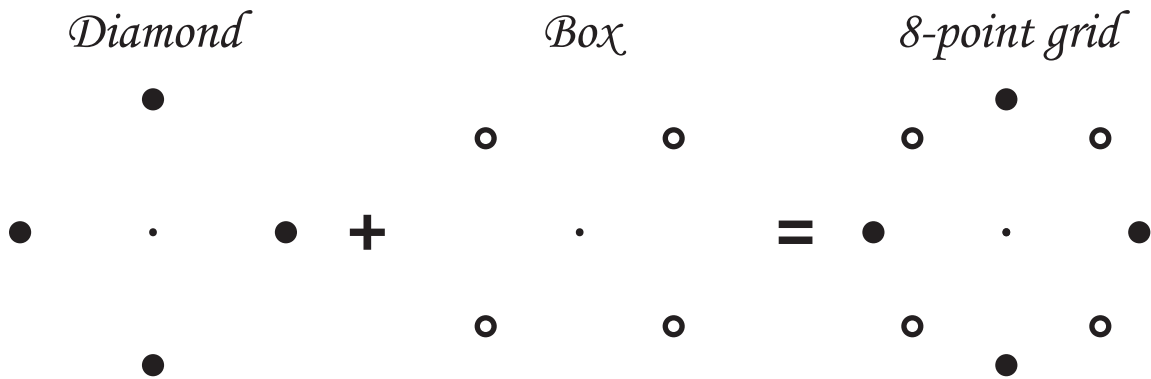
Try using both negative space and turns. Good luck!

The Grid

The Kinetic Alphabet is based on a 4-point grid.

There are two 4-point grids: box mode and diamond mode.

Together, diamond and box form an 8-point grid:



For now, we'll use diamond to learn each concept.

On this grid, there are three types of points:

Diamond

Outer Points depict the outer edges of the grid.

The **center point** is the hub that everything revolves around.

The four **hand points** are halfway between the center point and the outer points.

